

THE GLP-1 LIFESTYLE SERIES

The GLP-1 Meal Prep Playbook

High-Protein, Low-Nausea Recipes That Work

Disclaimer

This book is for educational and informational purposes only. It is not medical advice and does not constitute a recommendation to start, stop, or change any medication or treatment. GLP-1 receptor agonists are prescription medications that should only be used under the supervision of a qualified healthcare provider.

The nutritional guidance, exercise information, and lifestyle strategies in this book are general wellness information and are not tailored to your individual medical situation. Always consult your doctor, registered dietitian, or other qualified health professional before making changes to your diet, exercise routine, or medication management.

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Meal Prep on GLP-1 — Why It Matters More Than Usual

When appetite is suppressed, the foods you have available determine the foods you eat. Meal prep on GLP-1 is not about eating more — it's about ensuring that when appetite is limited, the available options are protein-forward, nutrient-dense, and easy to eat.

The Meal Prep Advantage

GLP-1 users who meal prep consistently eat more protein, make better food choices, and report fewer side effects than those who rely on spontaneous eating decisions. The reason is simple: when you're not hungry and food doesn't appeal, you default to whatever is easiest. If what's easiest is a bag of crackers, that's what you eat. If what's easiest is a pre-made bowl of Greek yoghurt with berries, or a container of chicken and roasted vegetables, that's what you eat instead.

The investment is two to three hours once or twice a week. The return is a week of eating that supports your goals without requiring daily effort or decision-making

about food.

GLP-1 Meal Prep Principles

Protein first in every container. Every meal prep item should anchor around a protein source. The protein goes in first, then vegetables, then carbohydrates if included.

Small portions by default. Prep in smaller containers than you'd normally use. Seeing a full container is psychologically different from seeing a normal-sized portion when appetite is suppressed. Smaller containers that feel completable are more likely to be eaten.

Temperature flexibility. Prep foods that are palatable cold, at room temperature, or warm. On high-nausea days, reheating food may feel impossible. Having options that work cold removes that barrier.

"You don't make food decisions when you're hungry on GLP-1. You make them when you're not. Meal prep is how you make decisions in advance."

High-Protein Recipes Designed for GLP-1

These recipes are designed specifically for the GLP-1 context: high in protein, easy on the stomach, tolerable on low-appetite days, and practical to prep in bulk.

Greek Yoghurt Protein Bowls

Base: 200g full-fat or 2% Greek yoghurt (20g protein).
Add: 30g protein powder mixed in (additional 20–25g protein), a tablespoon of almond butter (4g protein, healthy fat), a handful of berries, and a tablespoon of chia seeds (for fibre and omega-3).

Total protein: approximately 45–50g. Total preparation time: 3 minutes. These keep well in the refrigerator for up to three days and are palatable cold. The combination of yoghurt protein and whey protein provides both fast-digesting (whey) and slow-digesting (casein from yoghurt) protein sources.

Baked Chicken and Roasted Vegetables

Season 150–180g chicken breast with olive oil, garlic, smoked paprika, and salt. Bake at 200°C/400°F for 22–25 minutes. Alongside: roughly chop courgette, bell peppers, and cherry tomatoes, toss with olive oil and seasoning, roast for 20 minutes.

Prep eight servings at once: the cooking time is the same for one as for eight. Divide into containers. 150g chicken breast provides approximately 35g protein. The vegetables provide fibre, micronutrients, and enough volume to make the meal feel substantial.

Cottage Cheese and Egg Scramble

Two whole eggs scrambled with 100g cottage cheese: the cottage cheese melts into the eggs during cooking, creating a soft, high-protein scramble that is significantly higher in protein than eggs alone (25–28g total). Season simply with salt and chives.

This is one of the most nausea-friendly high-protein options because the texture is soft, the flavour is mild, and it's quick to make even when appetite is low. It also provides casein protein from the cottage cheese, which digests slowly and supports overnight muscle protein synthesis if eaten in the evening.

Tuna and White Bean Salad

One can of tuna in water (25g protein) mixed with half a can of white beans (7g protein), cherry tomatoes, cucumber, olive oil, lemon juice, and capers. Total protein approximately 32g. Can be eaten cold directly from the refrigerator. Prep six servings on Sunday.

The white beans add fibre that supports the constipation management critical on GLP-1. The olive oil provides healthy fat for fat-soluble vitamin absorption. The lemon and capers make this palatable even when appetite is low.

"Simple, protein-dense, and palatable on a bad day. That's the brief."

Navigating Eating Out on GLP-1

Most of life doesn't happen in your meal-prepped kitchen. Here's how to navigate restaurants, social eating, and travel.

Restaurant Strategies

Order protein first, and order it simply. Grilled or baked protein with vegetables is available at almost every restaurant. Sauces, complex preparations, and large portions are the main challenges — all of which worsen nausea. Asking for sauces on the side, ordering half portions, or sharing a main course are practical strategies that most restaurants accommodate without difficulty.

Don't feel obligated to finish. The social pressure to clean your plate is real, but eating past the point of comfortable fullness on GLP-1 produces significant discomfort. Eating slowly, stopping when you feel comfortable, and being honest with dining companions about your situation (if comfortable doing so) protects both your health and your enjoyment of the meal.

Travel and GLP-1

Air travel dehydrates. High-sodium airport food worsens fluid retention and compounds nausea. Long periods of sitting slow gut motility further. Pack protein-dense, portable snacks for travel: individual packets of nut butter, protein bars with at least 20g protein and reasonable ingredients, boiled eggs if carrying a cool bag.

Medication storage during travel: semaglutide and tirzepatide require refrigeration but can be at room temperature for up to 56 days (check your specific medication's guidance). A portable medication cooler is worth having for long-haul travel.

"The goal isn't perfect eating. It's good-enough eating in the real conditions of your actual life."

Building Sustainable Eating Patterns

The eating patterns you build on GLP-1 are the eating patterns you need to maintain after.

The Eating Pattern That Lasts

The Mediterranean dietary pattern — abundant vegetables, fruits, legumes, whole grains, olive oil, fish, moderate dairy and poultry, limited red meat and ultra-processed food — is the dietary pattern with the most consistent long-term evidence for weight maintenance, cardiovascular health, and metabolic health. It also happens to align naturally with the protein-first, high-vegetable approach appropriate on GLP-1.

Building the Mediterranean pattern habits during GLP-1 treatment means that when the medication stops — or the dose reduces — the dietary foundation is already in place. This is the evidence-based approach to preventing the weight regain that characterises GLP-1 treatment without lifestyle change.

*"You're not on a temporary diet. You're building
the eating pattern of the rest of your life."*
